About the Poet

Caroline Ann Bowles (1786-1854) was an English poet and the wife of Robert Southey, the poet laureate of Britain. She was a poet of great merit and produced some of the best work at the threshold of the Victorian era. She wrote various other works including *'The Little Ladybird', 'Chapter on Churchyard' and 'Tales of the Factories'.*

Glossary

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foliage (n) : a cluster of leaves, flowers and branches

glancing (adj) : touching or hitting something lightly from the side, without causing much damage

swelling (adj) : becoming greater in intensity or volume

rose-banks (n) : riverbanks where roses (flowers) appear along

impetuous (adj) : acting quickly and without thought or care

tending (adj) : going in a particular way

headlong (adv) : with the head first and the rest of the body following

hath (v) : in the past, the third person singular form of the word 'have'.

eternity (n) : life continuing without end after death

A. *Memorise the poem 'The River'

B. Read the following lines and answer the questions given below

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1. *O'er the yellow pebbles dancing,*
   Through the flowers and foliage glancing
   a) How does the river flow?
   b) What is meant by 'foliage'?

2. *River, river! Swelling river!*
   On you rush through rough and smooth;
   a) Why does the poet mention the river to be swelling?
   b) What are the surfaces the river flow through?

3. *Over rocks, by rose-banks, sweeping*
   Like impetuous youth.
   a) Where does the rose grow?
   b) Which stage of man is compared here?

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